



Campaign Manager's Field Manual

Matt Grant for Congress · Missouri's 2nd District

Lower costs. Stronger schools. Showing up.

End-to-end execution playbook — strategy, channels, apps & integrations

Window: **June 17** → **August 4, 2026 (Primary)** · General: Nov 3, 2026

Win number: **~16,500 votes** · Primary budget: **\$350,000**

Prepared for the campaign manager · compliance facts verified **2026-06-17**

Illustrative example. The candidate and dollar figures are fictional; district data, election dates, FEC contribution limits and reporting deadlines are real and web-sourced. Educational information, not legal advice — consult a campaign finance attorney or the FEC.

1 · The Race at a Glance

You have been hired as campaign manager for **Matt Grant** with **48 days** to the **August 4, 2026 Democratic primary** for U.S. House, MO-02. August 4 is the *primary* — winning it makes Matt the nominee for the **November 3 general**. This manual is scoped to winning the primary.

Item	Value	Item	Value
Office	U.S. House, MO-02	Jurisdiction	FEC + Missouri ballot access
Primary	Aug 4, 2026	District lean	Cook PVI R+4 (STL suburbs)
Win number (3-way)	~16,500 votes	Voter ID goal	35,000–40,000
Primary budget	\$350,000	Cash-on-hand by Jul 23	\$60,000+
Core message	“Lower costs, stronger schools, and a representative who actually shows up.”		

The four engines you run at once



Theory of victory. Consolidate the grassroots / electability share of the small primary electorate — concentrated in St. Louis County — behind one credible local candidate, while two opponents split the rest. Win it at the doors with the highest voter-contact operation in the race, not on TV.

Hard external dates (real, sourced · verified 2026-06-17)

Date	Event	Owner
Jul 15, 2026	FEC July Quarterly report due (covers Apr 1–Jun 30)	Treasurer
Jul 16–Aug 1	48-hour notice window for contributions ≥ \$1,000	Treasurer
Jul 23, 2026	FEC 12-Day Pre-Primary report due (covers Jul 1–15)	Treasurer
Aug 4, 2026	PRIMARY ELECTION DAY	All

Contribution limits (2025–2026): individual **\$3,500/election**; multicandidate PAC **\$5,000/election**. Primary and general are separate elections. Source: FEC.

2 · The Campaign Tech Stack

One source of truth per data type. Every channel carries the disclaimer and feeds data back. Tools marked

★ **CONNECTED** can be wired up directly from your assistant today (see Section 7).

Function	Recommended tool	Connected integration	Cost
Website / digital HQ	Next.js on Vercel	Vercel ★	\$
Donations / payments	ActBlue + Stripe (merch)	Stripe ★	% of raise
Donor / finance CRM	Numero / Airtable	via Drive	\$\$
Voter file & field CRM	VAN / PDI + MiniVAN	vendor	\$\$
Prospect / donor research	Apollo.io	Apollo ★	\$\$
Mass email (ESP)	ActBlue Express / Mailchimp	drafts via Lois247 ★	\$
Finance / VIP email (1:1)	Gmail	Gmail ★	\$
Peer-to-peer SMS	Scale to Win / Hustle	vendor	\$\$
Design / creative	Canva	Canva ★	\$
Video / YouTube growth	vidIQ + YouTube	vidIQ ★	\$
Content drafting	in-house + Lois247	Lois247 ★	\$
Team chat & ops	Slack	Slack ★	\$
Docs & storage	Google Drive	Drive ★	\$
Calendar / deadlines	Google Calendar	Calendar ★	\$
Diagrams / process maps	Mermaid	Mermaid ★	free
Website repo	GitHub	GitHub ★	free

Golden data rule. Money data → Donor CRM → FEC reports. People / volunteer / ID data → VAN → GOTV flush list. The website and ads only *acquire*; the CRMs *remember*.

3 · Week-1 Setup Sprint (stand up the whole stack)

Run this June 17–22 so every channel is live before the first full canvass weekend (Sat Jun 20).

Day	Build	Done when
Mon	Domain + Vercel site skeleton (splash → email capture + ActBlue button); Google Workspace (shared Drive, group inboxes)	Site live with working donate + sign-up
Tue	ActBlue page + Stripe for merch; donor CRM; import past-donor list via Apollo enrichment	A test \$5 donation flows into the CRM
Wed	Voter file / VAN access; cut Tier-1 turf; MiniVAN canvass app; P2P texting account pending	A canvasser can pull a turf packet on their phone
Thu	Social accounts claimed + branded; Canva brand kit (logo, colors, fonts); vidIQ + YouTube	All handles live with matching art + pinned intro
Fri	Slack workspace + channels + ops canvas; Calendar loaded with FEC deadlines + call time + shifts; Gmail finance templates drafted	Team in Slack; calendar shows Jul 15 / Jul 23 / Aug 4

Brand kit (lock Day 4, use everywhere)

- **Colors:** deep navy + warm red accent + clean white (suburban, trustworthy).
- **Logo lockup:** **GRANT** wordmark + “for Congress · MO-02”.
- **Tagline:** *Lower costs. Stronger schools. Showing up.*

4 · Channel Playbooks (quick-start cards)

Every paid or public item carries “**Paid for by Matt Grant for Congress.**” Full detail per channel is in 08-channel-implementation-playbook.md.

5.1 Website / HQ — Vercel

Goal: Convert visitors to donors, volunteers, emails.

Setup/cadence: Next.js template; pages = Home, Issues, About, Volunteer, Donate, Events, Press; forms → CRM.

KPI: Sign-ups/week; donate conversion %

5.2 Email — Gmail + ESP

Goal: 1:1 finance via Gmail; small-dollar via ESP.

Setup/cadence: 3–5 mass/week → daily final week; peak on Jul 15 & Jul 23 + final 72 hrs.

KPI: \$/email; open & click; list growth

5.3 Peer-to-peer SMS

Goal: GOTV, recruiting, deadline-day asks, ballot chase.

Setup/cadence: Opt-in numbers only; scripts mirror the field phone script; ramps with the chase.

KPI: IDs + ballot returns from texts

5.4 Social (organic) + Canva

Goal: Cheap reach, recruiting, momentum, rapid response.

Setup/cadence: Brand kit + templates; 1–2 posts/day across FB/IG/X/TikTok/YouTube.

KPI: Reach; sign-ups; share rate

5.5 Video / YouTube — vidIQ

Goal: Searchable, persuasive video library.

Setup/cadence: 1 anchor video/week + 2–3 shorts; launch, 3 issue shorts, testimonials, GOTV.

KPI: Retention %; search views; CTR

5.6 Paid digital ads

Goal: Cost-efficient persuasion + GOTV (no broadcast TV).

Setup/cadence: Verify political-advertiser status Week 1; live Jul 16; heavy-up final 10 days.

KPI: Cost per ID; cost per donor

5.7 Direct mail

Goal: Workhorse persuasion + GOTV (\$70K).

Setup/cadence: 4 pieces: intro → issues → contrast → GOTV (in homes by Jul 31).

KPI: Cost/piece; GOTV lift

5.8 Earned media / PR

Goal: Free credibility — local TV, Post-Dispatch, radio.

Setup/cadence: Press list + media kit; release at each milestone; op-ed mid-campaign.

KPI: Placements/week; share of voice

5.9 Field / canvassing

Goal: The engine: 35–40K IDs, turn out the 1s & 2s.

Setup/cadence: VAN + MiniVAN; canvass Thu/Sat/Sun → daily final 10 days; chase from early July.

KPI: IDs/day; contacts/shift; returns

5.10 Fundraising — ActBlue

Goal: Frictionless legal giving, reconciled for FEC.

Setup/cadence: Primary-designated page; limit checks wired in; surge on deadlines + final 72 hrs.

KPI: \$/day; avg gift; COH for Jul 23

5.11 Prospecting — Apollo

Goal: Build/enrich call-time + host-committee lists.

Setup/cadence: Import universe; enrich + segment by capacity; daily call sheets to candidate.

KPI: Qualified prospects/week

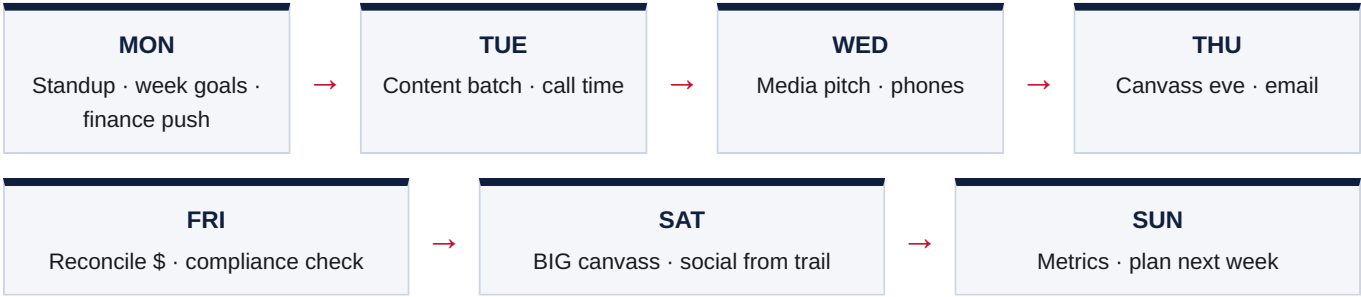
5.12 Ops — Slack/Drive/Calendar

Goal: One nervous system for staff + volunteers.

Setup/cadence: Channels + ops canvas; Drive mirrors the playbook; 8:30 standup; deadline reminders.

KPI: Standup adherence; deadline hit-rate

5 · The Weekly Operating Rhythm



- **Daily:** candidate call time (2–3 hrs) + a voter-contact shift + 1–2 social posts.
- **Weekly:** one earned-media hit, one email, one anchor video, one finance event, Sunday metrics.
- **Deadline weeks (Jul 15, Jul 23):** compliance + finance override everything else.

KPI Dashboard (post in Slack every Sunday)

Metric	Target by Aug 4	Source
Raised (cumulative)	\$350,000	Donor CRM / ActBlue
Cash on hand at Jul 23 report	\$60,000+	Donor CRM
Voter IDs	35,000–40,000	VAN
Confirmed 1–2 supporters	≥ 20,000	VAN
Active volunteers	150–250	VAN / Slack
FEC deadlines hit	100%	Compliance

6 · Compliance Overlay (wired into every tool)

- **Disclaimer** auto-included in site footer, email templates, ad accounts, mail proofs, paid-social presets, lit templates.
- **Limit checks** in the ActBlue/CRM intake flag anyone nearing **\$3,500** (primary).
- **48-hour-notice trigger:** a Slack alert + treasurer task fires on any **\$1,000+** gift during **Jul 16–Aug 1**.
- **Calendar reminders** for **Jul 15** and **Jul 23** set 5 days early.
- **Data privacy:** donor PII access-restricted; no SSNs / bank / card numbers stored.
- **Firewall:** zero coordination with Super PACs.
- **Never accept:** corporate/union treasury funds, foreign nationals, federal contractors, straw donors, cash over \$100.

This is educational information, not legal advice. Consult a campaign finance attorney or the FEC for guidance specific to your situation. Compliance facts verified 2026-06-17.

7 · What Your Assistant Can Execute Now

These are live integrations connected to this workspace. Pick any to start — I confirm before anything sends or publishes externally.

#	Action	Integration	Outward-facing?
1	Load FEC deadlines, call-time blocks & canvass shifts into your calendar	Google Calendar	Yes — changes your calendar
2	Draft the finance, endorsement & 6-email fundraising sequence as Gmail drafts	Gmail	No — drafts only
3	Design the brand kit, palm card, yard sign & a week of social graphics	Canva	No — creates designs
4	Generate YouTube titles, descriptions & thumbnails (launch + 3 issue shorts)	vidIQ	No — creates assets
5	Build the Slack ops canvas + channel structure + weekly metrics template	Slack	Yes — posts to workspace
6	Stand up the website skeleton & deploy a splash page	Vercel	Yes — public deploy
7	Build the call-time prospect list with enriched contacts	Apollo	No — internal list
8	Draft press releases & op-ed via the content engine	Lois247	No — drafts
9	Create the shared Drive folder structure mirroring this playbook	Google Drive	Yes — creates files

Recommended first moves (lowest risk, highest leverage): #2 Gmail drafts, #3 Canva creative, #1 Calendar deadlines, #5 Slack ops canvas.

Full strategy package: 01 Campaign Plan · 02 Compliance & Filing · 03 Fundraising · 04 Messaging · 05 Field & GOTV · 06 Execution Calendar · 07 Sample Artifacts · 08 Channel Implementation Playbook.